

LEMON-RASPBERRY CAKE

1 cup shortening
2 cups sugar
4 large eggs
3 cups sifted cake flour
2¹/₂ teaspoons baking powder
1/2 teaspoon salt
1 cup milk

Grease 3 (9-inch) round cakepans; line with wax paper. Grease and flour wax paper. Set pans aside.

Beat shortening at medium speed of an electric mixer until creamy; gradually add sugar, beating well. Add eggs, one at a time, beating well after each addition. Combine flour, baking powder, and salt; add to shortening mixture alternately with milk, beginning and ending with flour mixture. Mix after each addition. Stir in flavorings.

Pour batter into prepared pans. Bake at 375° for 18 to 20 minutes or until a wooden pick inserted in center comes out clean.

1 teaspoon almond extract
1 teaspoon vanilla extract
1 (10-ounce) jar seedless
raspberry preserves
Lemon Buttercream Frosting
Garnish: lemon slice wedges

Cool in pans on wire racks 10 minutes; remove from pans, and let cool completely on wire racks.

Slice cake layers in half horizontally to make 6 layers. Place 1 layer, cut side up, on a cake plate; spread with 3 tablespoons preserves. Repeat procedure with remaining 5 layers and preserves, omitting preserves on top of last layer.

Reserve 1 cup Lemon Buttercream Frosting; spread remaining 1³/₄ cups frosting on top and sides of cake. Using a star tip, pipe reserved frosting on top of cake. Garnish, if desired. Store in an airtight container in refrigerator.

Yield: one 6-layer cake.

Lemon Buttercream Frosting

1¹/₄ cups butter or margarine softened
2 teaspoons grated lemon rind

Beat first 3 ingredients at medium speed of an electric mixer until creamy.

3 tablespoons lemon juice
3 cups sifted powdered sugar

Gradually add powdered sugar, beating until frosting is of spreading consistency.

Yield: 2³/₄ cups.